

AHMED BAHGAT

Digital Transformation & Enterprise Architecture Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Digital transformation leader with 20+ years architecting and delivering technology innovation for tier-1 telecom operators across the Gulf region. Dual expertise in enterprise architecture and program execution—designing complex, multi-million-dollar transformation strategies and driving them to successful completion. Core strengths in Enterprise Architecture, mega-scale program delivery, IT Operating Model optimization, and emerging technology integration (AIOps, AI/ML, Cloud).

Established EA practices from ground up and successfully managed end-to-end transformation programs for STC, Du, and Vodafone, consistently delivering projects on time, within budget, while achieving cost optimization and enhanced profitability.

Key Strengths:

Design & Execute: Architect enterprise transformation strategies and manage their delivery through successful implementation—bridging vision with results

Lead Complex Programs: Direct mega-scale initiatives involving distributed teams, intricate dependencies, and significant financial investment

Align & Optimize: Connect technology investments to business priorities while redesigning operating models for sustained value

Deliver Measurable Impact: Drive quantifiable business outcomes—cost savings, operational improvements, and competitive positioning

Build & Influence: Cultivate C-level relationships through consultative approach, solution selling, and strategic business development

KEY TRANSFORMATION ACHIEVEMENTS

- PRACTICE & CAPABILITY DEVELOPMENT

- EA Practice Establishment: Built Enterprise Architecture practice from ground up with governance framework, repository, principles and policies
- Operating Model Design: Redesigned Service Management Office blueprint achieving 30% first-year OPEX reduction and 15% YoY continuous optimization
- Strategic Roadmaps: Developed 3-year enterprise capability mapping and technology roadmaps for 20+ streams including ITSM, monitoring, and security

- Cost Optimization Initiatives:

- Managed application portfolio governance initiative for 500 business applications, realizing consolidation and vendor unification opportunities which reduced maintenance costs by 30M SAR for Apps GD
- Implemented 'Demand to Fulfill' journey automation integrating stc Hub, Jira and CMDB
- Managed the IT Asset and Monitoring operating model that streamlined governance of licenses and HW assets tracking, reduction of license renewals by 10 M SAR after monitoring Oracle and

Microsoft licenses

- Built RPA automation practice delivered 40% less execution time for selected process in HR, Finance and Operations IT units
- Unified 25+ legacy tools into single observability platform saving 20M SAR; consolidated IT/Telecom ticketing systems in 20M SAR project
- Consolidation of 5+ monitoring tools under EMC SAS unified monitoring, delivering operational efficiency improvements and achieving 20M SAR in cost savings.

- **TRANSFORMATION LEADERSHIP**

- Pioneered AIOps Business order monitoring solution reducing MTTR by 60%.
- Pioneered blockchain POC for STC Pay payment reconciliation.
- Designed complex service models for telecom services using BMC ADDM/CMDB.

- **Operational Excellence:**

- Led business process automation initiative with BCG and KPMG to digitize devops journeys
- Technical project steerwardship for SIEM implementation project monitoring 25,000 assets.
- NOC Monitoring dashboard and Service Management Office framework based on ITIL framework.
- Steered the End-End Service Monitoring Solution providing full stack and service transaction monitoring cross the digital stack using Opentext ITOM suite of solutions with budget of 8M SAR.
- Program Management for Remedy ITSM consolidation program of 20M SAR and delivering a unified ticketing solution and new organization structure, processes across IT and Network.
- Architecture management for BMC Remedy (IT) upgrade project.
- Service Management Office, setup of cross functional Service Management Office organization (Technology, Process and People) in collaboration with BMC.
- SPOC for Applications GD in the Dev-Sec-Ops model.

- **OTHER MAJOR ENGAGEMENTS**

- Ooredoo Qatar: Led flagship ITSM transformation program with HP BTO suite (7M QR budget).
- Du UAE: Architected Managed Services NOC operations solution (60M USD IT component).
- Etisalat Pakistan & Tunisie Telecom: Delivered NOC process re-engineering and ITSM implementation.
- Saudi Post & Amanat Jeddah: Developed comprehensive NOC and ITSM process blueprints.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Enterprise Architect- Service Assurance and Observability

Saudi Telecom Company (STC), Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | 2020 – Present

Enterprise Architect, Technical PMO and Advisor to Management for engagements under IT Operations Management and end-end Service assurance domains.

Managing architecture blueprints and annual operating budgets for 20 technology streams across enterprise.

- Owned complete RFP lifecycle for service management portfolio including Enterprise Monitoring, IT Assets, ITSM, Operations Dashboards
- Developed enterprise architecture artifacts and governance framework for all service management projects and strategy aligned with stc Raqami Digital Transformation objectives.
- Led technology acquisition projects from benchmarking, cost/benefit analysis, gap analysis and target roadmap to rfp release and awarding, ending with delivery and benefits realization.

- Project Delivery Governance and Benefits Realization Management, Managing stc cross functional teams and, direct/govern vendors' strategies and Project management Approach and Deliverables.
- Manage Programs Schedules, budgets, escalations and overall implementation roadmap and reporting to stc Technology architecture and PMO teams the strategic deliverables KPIs,

Service Management & Enterprise Transformation Lead

Saudi Telecom Company (STC), Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | 2015 – 2019

- Demand SPOC for all stc Enterprise ITSM and Monitoring and Asset Management projects managing budget of with yearly budget exceeding 15M SAR.
- Contributed to strategy, architecture, and governance of STC's IT Asset Management initiatives.
- Responsible for RFP cycle for related streams, technology assessments and cost- benefit analyses to ensure optimal transformation investments.
- Led technology evaluations for major platform consolidations (ServiceNow/BMC Remedy) and the adoption of emerging technologies.
- Served as Product Owner for critical transformation deliverables, including unified NOC Monitoring and Service Monitoring modernization.
- Achieved 15% year-over-year reduction in software licensing through IT Asset Governance program
- Project Delivery Governance and Benefits Realization Management, managing stc teams' responsibilities and, vendor's committed Schedules, budgets, escalations and overall implementation progress for following projects:
 - Centralized observability platform & consolidating 5+ legacy monitoring tools, resulting in 20M SAR in savings.
 - Custom built 7M SAR, Real-time order monitoring infrastructure (Flink, Kafka, Apache Hadoop, ELK dashboards featuring ML-based anomaly detection and advanced orders analytics).
 - Enterprise SIEM solution to manage assets across IT and Network sectors, covering 25,000 security assets.
 - Implemented Service Management Office in collaboration with BMC resulting in 40% improvement in successful infrastructure changes in first year.

End-End Solution Architect / Business Consultant

Alcatel-Lucent, Middle East & Africa | 2010 – 2014

MEA Regional Lead for OSS transformation solutions, responsible for opportunity qualification, strategy planning, solution architecture coordination for big projects across MEA Region.

- Provided strategic technology advisory to C-level executives reacted to emerging technologies such as Cloudband and HLN, developing comprehensive technology transformation roadmaps and strategic IT investment strategies.

Achievements

- Led cross-functional teams through RFP response cycles for tier-1 operators (Etisalat, Du, Vodafone, MTN).
- Design of target operating models for Managed services solutions for Du UAE CNMS exceeding 60 M\$ for IT Service Operations Center.
- Technical Program Management for complete end-end managed services transformation projects for Du UAE CNMS, Bharti Airtel Africa, and Reliance Wireless India
- Developed OSS transformation blueprint for UK Rail aligned with eTOM & TAM frameworks.
- End-end managed services for Etisalat GNMS, Mobily NOC, Djezzy 3G NOC

- UK Rail: OSS roadmap aligned with eTOM & TAM frameworks
 - OSS/NOC/SOC for regional telecommunications operators including Etisalat, MTN, and Vodafone
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ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Solution Architecture Manager

HP Delivery Partner - Fingerprint Consultancy, Egypt & Saudi Arabia | 2008–2010

- Technical Delivery Management for Mega Scale Project of 10M QR ITSM Transformation at Ooredoo: IT Service Management transformation, starting with operational maturity assessment.
- HP BTO projects for telecoms: Etisalat Pakistan (ufone), and Tunisie Telecom in (ITSM, Asset Management and ITOM)
- Tunisie Telecom: Designed NOC processes and KPIs with HP ITSM deployment
- Etisalat Pakistan: Delivered \$8M ITSM transformation across regional operations
- Led transformation initiatives across MEA, Pakistan, and Far East markets, establishing repeatable transformation methodologies and accelerating market entry.

Presales Lead

Premium Cisco Partner - BMB, Egypt | 2005 – 2007

- Pre-sales lead who designed competitive Cisco enterprise solutions in Network, IP Telephony, Security, and Datacenter for customers in government, telecom and financial sectors

IT Consultant

USAID - Pal-Tech, Cairo | 2002 – 2005

- Managed technical aspects of a datacenter implementation for country wide edtech project "IT in Schools" with 10M\$ budget

Systems Integration Engineer

Premium Microsoft Partner - ATG, Egypt | 1997 – 2002

- Designed and Delivered Active Directory and Exchange implementations for enterprise customers

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategic Advisory & Value Creation:

- C-Level Technology Advisory
- Investment Strategy & Business Cases
- Vendor Strategy & Management
- Risk Assessment & Mitigation
- Performance Optimization & Cost Reduction

Transformation Leadership & Governance:

- Change Management Strategy
- Transformation Program Management
- Benefits Realization Management
- Organizational Design & Capability Development

Strategy And Architecture:

- Enterprise Transformation Strategy
- Business Process Reengineering
- Technology Roadmap Design
- Digital Operating Model Design
- Legacy Modernization Architecture

Solution Design & Innovation:

- End-to-End Solution Architecture
 - Technology Portfolio Optimization
 - Cloud Transformation Strategy
 - AIOPs & AI (Agentic AI, RAG projects)
 - Observability and Service Management Solutions
 - Data & Analytics Architecture
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CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

Professional Certifications:

TOGAF 9.1 Certified Architect | IT4IT Foundation | CGEIT - Certified in Governance of Enterprise IT | CISA - Certified Information Systems Auditor | COBIT Auditor | ITIL v3 Foundation | Lean IT Kaizen Certified | TMForum Business Process Framework | Business Architecture Guild Member

Education:

B.Sc. Information Systems Management - Sadat Academy for Management Sciences (1996)